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BATTERY PACK TRAVEL CHARGER AND BATTERY PACK HOLDER

Abstract

A battery pack accessory including a cylindrical housing, a terminal block configured to connect to a battery pack, an output port provided on the housing for providing an output current to a heated garment, and a controller located within the cylindrical housing and including an electronic processor and a memory. The controller is coupled to the terminal block and the output port. The controller is configured to determine that the battery pack is connected to the terminal block, determine that the heated garment is coupled to the battery pack accessory at the output port, and provide the output current to the heated garment in response to determining that the battery pack is connected to the terminal block and the heated garment is coupled to the battery pack accessory at the output port.

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Background/Summary

CROSS-REFERENCE TO RELATED APPLICATIONS

[0001] This application claims priority to Chinese Patent Application No. 202410230532.8, filed on Feb. 29, 2024, the entire contents of which are incorporated herein by reference.

FIELD

[0002] The present disclosure relates to battery packs and, more particularly, to a travel charger and a holder for a battery pack.

SUMMARY

[0003] Battery packs provide power sources for devices of varying sizes and in varying locations based on the portability of the battery packs. For example, battery packs may provide power to a power tool, heated gear, and handheld devices, such as, for example, mobile phones and tablets. With respect to heated gear, such as a heated garment, a compact battery pack may be used over a larger, bulkier battery so as not to constrain the user's movement while wearing the heated gear. The compact battery pack may be recharged using a battery pack charger, which may be external to the heated gear or incorporated into the gear.

[0004] A battery pack, such as a compact battery pack used with heated gear, may be used with a battery pack holder. For example, with respect to heated gear, the gear may include a compact, exterior device with a port or recess for receiving the compact battery pack and a heated gear power port providing power to the heated gear as discharged by the battery pack. Similar to the battery pack charger, the battery pack holder may be incorporated in the heated gear or external to the heated gear.

[0005] The present disclosure provides, among other things, a travel battery pack charger and a corresponding battery pack holder for a compact battery pack. The travel battery pack charger and the battery pack holder include ports for providing power to heated gear. In some embodiments, the travel battery pack charger also includes an additional port, separate from the port that provides power to the heated gear for providing power to an external device, such as, for example, a mobile phone, a power tool, a laptop, a tablet, a smart wearable device, etc. The compact size of the travel battery pack charger and battery pack holder provides a minimal amount of additional weight to heated gear, and, thus, does not hinder the user's movement as much as larger and bulkier battery packs and associated accessories (e.g., chargers and holders).

[0006] For example, some embodiments described herein provide a battery pack accessory. The battery pack accessory includes a cylindrical housing, a terminal block configured to connect to a battery pack, an output port provided on the housing for providing an output current to a heated garment, and a controller located within the cylindrical housing and including an electronic processor and a memory. The controller is coupled to the terminal block and the output port. The controller is configured to determine that the battery pack is connected to the terminal block, determine that the heated garment is coupled to the battery pack accessory at the output port, and provide the output current to the heated garment.

[0007] A further embodiment described herein provides a system. The system includes a battery

pack, and a battery pack accessory. The battery pack accessory including a cylindrical housing, a terminal block supported by the cylindrical housing and configured to connect to the battery pack, an output port provided on the cylindrical housing for providing an output current to a heated garment, and a controller located within the cylindrical housing and including an electronic processor and a memory. The controller is coupled to the terminal block and the output port and is configured to determine that the battery pack is connected to the terminal block, determine that the heated garment is coupled to the battery pack accessory at the output port, and provide the output current to the heated garment in response to determining that the battery pack is connected to the terminal block and determining that the heated garment is coupled to the battery pack accessory at the output port.

[0008] A further embodiment described herein provides a method of providing an output current to a heated garment from a battery pack. The method includes determining, with a controller of a battery pack accessory, that the battery pack is connected to a terminal block of the battery pack accessory, determining, with the controller of the battery pack accessory, that the heated garment is coupled to the battery pack accessory, wherein the heated garment is coupled to the battery pack accessory at an output port, and in response to determining that the battery pack is connected to the terminal block and the heated garment is coupled to the battery pack accessory at the output port, providing, with the controller of the battery pack accessory, a first output current from the battery pack to the heated garment.

[0009] Other features and aspects of the invention will become apparent by consideration of the following detailed description and accompanying drawings.

Description

BRIEF DESCRIPTION OF THE DRAWINGS

[0010] FIG. 1 illustrates a battery pack for powering a heated garment, according to some embodiments.

[0011] FIG. 2 illustrates a front view of a heated garment, according to some embodiments.

[0012] FIG. 3 illustrates a back view of a heated garment, according to some embodiments.

[0013] FIG. 4 illustrates another heated garment, according to some embodiments.

[0014] FIGS. 5A and 5B each illustrate a travel battery pack charger for the battery pack of FIG. 1, according to some embodiments.

[0015] FIG. 6 illustrates a first internal view of the travel battery pack charger of FIG. 5A or 5B, according to some embodiments.

[0016] FIG. 7 illustrates a second internal view of the travel battery pack charger of FIG. 5A or 5B, according to some embodiments.

[0017] FIG. 8 illustrates a battery pack holder for the battery pack of FIG. 1, according to some embodiments.

[0018] FIG. 9 illustrates a first internal view of the battery pack holder of FIG. 8, according to some embodiments.

[0019] FIG. 10 illustrates a second internal view of the battery pack holder of FIG. 8, according to some embodiments.

[0020] FIG. 11 is a block control diagram of the travel battery pack charger of FIG. 5A or 5B, according to some embodiments.

[0021] FIG. 12 is a block control diagram of the battery pack holder of FIG. 8, according to some embodiments.

[0022] FIG. 13 is a block control diagram of a heated garment, according to some embodiments.

[0023] FIG. 14A illustrates a dual connector from the heated garment of FIG. 2, according to some embodiments.

[0024] FIGS. 14B and 14C each illustrate a dual connector port for the travel battery pack charger of FIG. 5A or 5B, according to some embodiments.

[0025] FIG. 14D illustrates a dual connector port for the battery pack holder of FIG. 8, according to some embodiments.

[0026] FIG. 15 illustrates a user interface for the heated garment of FIG. 2, according to some embodiments.

[0027] FIG. 16 illustrates a user interface for the travel battery pack charger of FIG. 5A or 5B, according to some embodiments.

[0028] FIG. 17 illustrates a power distribution system for the travel battery pack charger of FIG. 5A or 5B, according to some embodiments.

[0029] FIG. 18 illustrates a power distribution system for the battery pack holder of FIG. 8, according to some embodiments.

[0030] FIG. 19 is a flow chart illustrating a method of operating the travel battery pack charger of FIG. 5A or 5B, according to some embodiments.

[0031] FIG. 20 is a flow chart illustrating a method of operating the battery pack holder of FIG. 8, according to some embodiments.

DETAILED DESCRIPTION

[0032] Before any embodiments are explained in detail, it is to be understood that the embodiments are not limited in its application to the details of the configuration and arrangement of components set forth in the following description or illustrated in the accompanying drawings. The embodiments are capable of being practiced or of being carried out in various ways. Also, it is to be understood that the phraseology and terminology used herein are for the purpose of description and should not be regarded as limiting. The use of “including,” “comprising,” or “having” and variations thereof are meant to encompass the items listed thereafter and equivalents thereof as well as additional items. Unless specified or limited otherwise, the terms “mounted,” “connected,” “supported,” and “coupled” and variations thereof are used broadly and encompass both direct and indirect mountings, connections, supports, and couplings.

[0033] In addition, it should be understood that embodiments may include hardware, software, and electronic components or modules that, for purposes of discussion, may be illustrated and described as if the majority of the components were implemented solely in hardware. However, one of ordinary skill in the art, and based on a reading of this detailed description, would recognize that, in at least one embodiment, the electronic-based aspects may be implemented in software (e.g., stored on non-transitory computer-readable medium) executable by one or more processing units, such as a microprocessor and/or application specific integrated circuits (“ASICs”). As such, it should be noted that a plurality of hardware and software based devices, as well as a plurality of different structural components, may be utilized to implement the embodiments. For example, “servers,” “computing devices,” “controllers,” “processors,” etc., described in the specification can include one or more processing units, one or more computer-readable medium modules, one or more input/output interfaces, and various connections (e.g., a system bus) connecting the components.

[0034] Relative terminology, such as, for example, “about,” “approximately,”

[0035] “substantially,” etc., used in connection with a quantity or condition would be understood by those of ordinary skill to be inclusive of the stated value and has the meaning dictated by the context (e.g., the term includes at least the degree of error associated with the measurement accuracy, tolerances [e.g., manufacturing, assembly, use, etc.] associated with the particular value, etc.). Such terminology should also be considered as disclosing the range defined by the absolute values of the two endpoints. For example, the expression “from about 2 to about 4” also discloses the range “from 2 to 4”. The relative terminology may refer to plus or minus a percentage (e.g., 1%, 5%, 10%, or more) of an indicated value.

[0036] It should be understood that although certain drawings illustrate hardware and software located within particular devices, these depictions are for illustrative purposes only. Functionality

described herein as being performed by one component may be performed by multiple components in a distributed manner. Likewise, functionality performed by multiple components may be consolidated and performed by a single component. In some embodiments, the illustrated components may be combined or divided into separate software, firmware and/or hardware. For example, instead of being located within and performed by a single electronic processor, logic and processing may be distributed among multiple electronic processors. Regardless of how they are combined or divided, hardware and software components may be located on the same computing device or may be distributed among different computing devices connected by one or more networks or other suitable communication links. Similarly, a component described as performing particular functionality may also perform additional functionality not described herein. For example, a device or structure that is “configured” in a certain way is configured in at least that way but may also be configured in ways that are not explicitly listed.

[0037] FIG. 1 illustrates a battery pack 2 for providing power to and communicating with a heated garment, such as heated jacket 10 (FIG. 2), a heated glove 50 (FIG. 4), and/or other type of garment or gear. The battery pack 2 includes a housing 4 and an interface portion 6 for connecting the battery pack 2 to one of a travel battery pack charger 100 (FIGS. 5A and 5B), a battery pack holder 200 (FIG. 8), and a power tool. Additionally, in some embodiments, the interface portion 6 may be configured for connecting the battery pack 2 to a heated garment (e.g., the heated jacket 10 and/or heated glove 50). In some embodiments, the battery pack 2 includes a connection port for receiving input power to charge rechargeable battery cells within the housing 4. For example, the connection port may be one of a Universal Serial Bus (USB), Universal Serial Bus Type-C (USB-C), or a Universal Serial Bus Power Delivery (USB-PD) port.

[0038] In some embodiments, the battery pack 2 includes one or more lithium-ion battery cells. In other embodiments, the battery pack 2 may be of a different chemistry, for example, nickel-cadmium, nickel-metal hydride, and the like. The battery cells may take various shapes and configurations. For example, in some embodiments, the battery cells may include one or more cylindrical cells, one or more pouch cells, one or more prismatic cells, or a combination thereof. In some embodiments, the battery pack 2 may include anywhere in the range of three to six battery cells 15. In some embodiments, the battery pack 2 may include two large 10 ampere-hours (A/hr), 3.7 volt (V) battery cells. These larger-sized battery cells provide an increased runtime in comparison to conventional battery cells. In some embodiments, the battery cells may be 74 watts-hour (W/hr) battery cells. In some embodiments, the increase in W/hr of the battery cells would proportionally increase the runtime. For example, doubling the W/hr would double the runtime. In some embodiments, the density of the battery cells may be increased from conventional densities. In the illustrated embodiment, the battery pack 2 is a 12V battery pack outputting a constant 12V output. In other embodiments, the output voltage level of the battery pack 2 may be different. For example, the battery pack 2 may be a 4V battery pack, 18V battery pack, 28V battery pack, 40V battery pack, or another voltage. The battery pack 2 may also have various capacities (e.g., 3, 4, 5, 6, 8, or 12 A/hr). The output of the battery cells may be in the range of 3.0-6.0 Ampere-hours (Ah).

[0039] FIG. 2 illustrates a heated garment 10. The illustrated heated garment 10 is a heated jacket. The heated jacket 10 may be constructed in various sizes to fit a variety of users. The heated jacket 10 includes typical jacket features, such as, for example, a torso body 12, two arms 14, a collar 16, and one or more front pockets 18. As illustrated in cutaway portions of FIGS. 2 and 3, the heated jacket 10 includes a heater array 26. In some embodiments, the heater array 26 is disposed in both a left portion 28 and a right portion 30 of the torso body 12. In some embodiments, the heater array 26 may extend into the arms 14 and/or collar 16. The heater array 26 may be configured to generate heat based on a received DC voltage from the battery pack 2. In some embodiments, the heater array 26 may receive the DC voltage from the battery pack 2 via the travel battery pack charger 100 or the battery pack holder 200. For example, the heater array 26 may be a resistive heater array. However, other heater array types are also contemplated. In other embodiments, the heated jacket

10 may include a first heater array and second heater array arranged as an upper module and a lower module, respectively. In the illustrated embodiment, the heater array **26** is controlled by one of the battery pack **2** and the heated jacket **10** based on input from an external device. In other embodiments, multiple heater arrays may be controlled individually via a single control input or multiple control inputs. For example, the multiple heater arrays may be isolated and controlled by the battery pack **2** based on input from the device. The heater array **26** may include resistive heating coils formed of carbon fibers, high density carbon fibers, or other heating devices. In some embodiments, the heated jacket **10** is configured to maintain a temperature of up to 110 degrees) (° Fahrenheit, although in other embodiments, lower or greater temperatures are possible depending upon the type of heater array **26**.

[0040] In some embodiments, the heater array **26** may include a negative temperature coefficient thermistor (NTC) or a positive temperature coefficient thermistor (PTC) to determine temperature. For example, the NTC or PTC is coupled to the heater array **26** to determine the heater array **26** temperature. In some embodiments where a carbon fiber element is implemented in the heated garment, an NTC or PTC may be used. The NTC or PTC may be added to the heater array **26** on or close to the carbon fiber element and an ambient surface of the garment. In some embodiments where a conductive ink heater is implemented in a heated garment, the current required to provide heat to the heater array may be determined by a current sensor. For example, a PTC may be provided to the heater array which reduce the current drawn by the heater array as the temperature of the heater array increases.

[0041] As illustrated in cutout 3-3 of FIG. 3, the heated jacket **10** includes a compartment **32** located on a lower portion of the back torso body. The compartment **32** houses an electrical component, such as the battery pack **2**, which may be held within one of the travel battery pack charger **100** and the battery pack holder **200**. The heated jacket **10** includes a connector, such as dual connector **630** (FIG. 14A), for connecting the heater arrays **26** to one of the travel battery pack charger **100** and the battery pack holder **200**.

[0042] In some embodiments, the heated jacket **10** may include a controller, such as controller **400** (FIG. 12). The controller **400** may communicate with one of a travel battery pack charger controller, such as controller **300** (FIG. 11), and a battery pack holder controller, such as controller **500** (FIG. 13). In some embodiments, the heated jacket **10** may include at least one connection port for connecting to other heated garments. For example, the connection port(s) may be a USB, USB-C, or USB-PD port. The connection port(s) may be located on the torso body **12**, arms **14**, and/or collar **16** of the heated jacket **10**. Garments connected to the heated jacket **10** via the connection port may receive input power from the battery pack **2** and may be controlled by one of the travel battery pack charger **100** (specifically, by the travel battery pack charger controller **300**) and the battery pack holder **200** (specifically, by the battery pack holder controller **500**) that is connected to the heated jacket **10**.

[0043] FIG. 4 illustrates another heated garment **50**. The illustrated heated garment **50** is a heated glove. The heated glove **50** includes a heater array **55** and a connector **60**. For example, the connector **60** may be a USB, USB-C, or USB-PD plug. The connector **60** may electrically and, optionally, communicatively couple the heated glove **50** to the heated jacket **10**. The heater array **55** may be powered and controlled by the battery pack **2** that is coupled to the heated jacket **10**. For example, the heater array **55** may be able to provide varying heating levels to a user wearing the heated glove **50** based on input from the battery pack **2** that receives input from the external device. In some embodiments, the heated glove **50** may be a mitten.

[0044] FIG. 5A illustrates the travel battery pack charger **100** (hereinafter “charger **100**”). The charger **100** includes a housing **102**, an output port **104**, a cover **106** for a bi-directional port, a power button **108**, and a fuel gauge **110**. In some embodiments, the charger **100** is substantially cylindrical. The battery pack **2** is received at a first end **103** of the charger **100**. The battery pack **2** and the charger **100** have similar outer configurations (e.g., shapes and sizes) such that the battery

pack 2 and the charger 100 create a generally continuous outer surface when the battery pack 2 is connected to the charger 100. The first end 103 of the charger 100 is perpendicular to a longitudinal axis 105 of the battery pack 2 and the charger 100. In some embodiments, the first end 103 is not a linear line around a circumference of the housing 102. For example, the first end 103 may be an open end of the housing that follows a substantially stepped and sloped line. The cover 106, the power button 108, and the fuel gauge 110 are arranged on a second end 107 of the charger 100, parallel to the first end 103 of the charger 100. In some embodiments, the second end 107 may include a first flat portion and a second, slightly sloped portion. The output port 104 may be a dual barrel port including a first barrel and a second barrel provided adjacent to one another along the longitudinal axis 105. In some embodiments, the output port 104 provides output power from the battery pack 2 to the heated jacket 10. For example, the output port 104 may provide 26 Watts (W) to the heated jacket 10 from the battery pack 2. In some embodiments, the fuel gauge 110 visually indicates a power level of the battery pack 2.

[0045] FIG. 5B illustrates the charger 100 according to an alternative implementation. In particular, FIG. 5B illustrates a ridge 111 positioned around the output port 104 that extends laterally from the longitudinal axis 105. The ridge 111 may take various shapes and sizes and may be positioned entirely around the output port 104 or around at least a portion of the output port 104. The ridge 111 may protect a dual connector connected to the output port 104 and, in some implementations, may be sized and/or shaped to interface with the dual connector. As illustrated in FIG. 5B, in some implementations, the ridge 111 is also positioned around an attachment member 112 (e.g., a slot, a hinge, a pivot point, etc.) configured to attach to a door or cover for the output port 104 (e.g., a door or cover for a cavity formed via the ridge 111). Further details regarding covers for the output port 104 are provided below with respect to FIGS. 14B and 14C.

[0046] In some embodiments, the cover 106 is a removable cover. For example, the cover 106 provides a barrier between a bi-directional port, such as bi-directional port 114 (FIG. 6), and the environment around the charger 100. In some embodiments, the cover 106 is made of a rubber material. For example, the material may be Fluorosilicone rubber that is resistant to chemicals and solvents and has an operating range of -60° to 200° C. In some embodiments, the bi-directional port 114 is a USB-C port. In some embodiments, the power button 108 may be depressed to control a flow of power from the battery pack 2 to a device, such as device 325 (FIG. 17), which may be a mobile phone, a power tool, a laptop, a tablet, a smart wearable device, or the like. In other embodiments, the power button 108 may be a slidable switch or a rotatable dial. In some embodiments, power may be simultaneously provided from the battery pack 2 to the heated jacket 10 via the output port 104 and to the device 325 via the bi-directional port 114. The battery pack 2 may receive a charging voltage from the charger 100 when the device 325 provides a charging voltage to the charger 100 via the bi-directional port 114. In some embodiments, the fuel gauge 110 illuminates in response to the charger 100 outputting a voltage and in response to the charger 100 receiving a voltage. For example, in a discharge mode, the fuel gauge 110 may illuminate a first color and, in a charge mode, the fuel gauge 110 may illuminate a second color that is different than the first color. As also described above, in some embodiments, an indicator, such as, for example, the power button 108, may provide information regarding a status of the bi-directional port 114.

[0047] FIG. 6 illustrates a first internal view of the charger 100. The charger 100 includes a first printed circuit board (PCB) 112, a second PCB 118, a third PCB 122, and a terminal block 124. In some embodiments, the first PCB 112, the second PCB 118, the third PCB 122, and the terminal block 124 are stacked on top of one another along the longitudinal axis 105. For example, the first PCB 112 is provided nearest to the second end 107 of the charger 100 followed by the second PCB 118, the third PCB 122, and the terminal block 124 in that order.

[0048] The bi-directional port 114 and a communication port 116 are provided on the first PCB 112. The bi-directional port 114 may be provided directly underneath the cover 106. The communication port 116 may be a first port of the output port 104. In some embodiments, the

communication port **116** may be provided above a first side of the first PCB **112**. For example, the communication port **116** may not contact the first PCB **112**. A heated garment voltage port **120** may be provided below a second side, opposite the first side, of the first PCB **112** and on the second PCB **118**. In some embodiments, the heated garment voltage port **120** may contact the second side of the first PCB **112**. The heated garment voltage port **120** may be a second port of the output port **104**. In some embodiments, the heated garment voltage port **120** has a larger diameter than the communication port **116** and may be a different type of port than the communication port **116**. Additional circuit components may be provided on the first PCB **112**, the second PCB **118**, the third PCB **122**, or a combination thereof. The terminal block **124** may electrically and mechanically connect the battery pack **2** to the charger **100**. For example, the terminal block **124** may include mechanical interface components and electrical interface components. In some embodiments, the terminal block **124** may be electrically connected to the first PCB **112**, the second PCB **118**, and the third PCB **122**.

[0049] FIG. 7 illustrates a second internal view of the charger **100**. The battery pack **2** is partially received within the charger **100** and connected to the terminal block **124** in a bottom portion of the charger. The first PCB **112**, the second PCB **118**, and the third PCB **122** are provided in a top portion of the charger **100**.

[0050] FIG. 8 illustrates the battery pack holder **200** (hereinafter “holder **200**”). The holder **200** includes a housing **202** and an output port **204**. In some embodiments, the holder **200** is substantially cylindrical. The battery pack **2** is received at a first end **203** of the holder **200**. The battery pack **2** and the holder **200** have similar outer configurations (e.g., shapes and sizes) such that the battery pack **2** and the holder **200** create a generally continuous outer surface when the battery pack **2** is connected to the holder **200**. The first end **203** of the holder **200** is perpendicular to a longitudinal axis **205** of the battery pack **2** and the holder **200**. In some embodiments, the first end **203** is not a linear line around a circumference of the housing **202**. For example, the first end **203** may be an open end of the housing **202** that follows a substantially stepped and sloped line. The output port **204** may be a dual barrel port including a first barrel and a second barrel provided adjacent to one another along the longitudinal axis **205** adjacent to a second end **209** of the holder **200**. In some embodiments, the second end **209** may include a first flat portion and a second, slightly sloped portion. In some embodiments, the output port **204** provides output power from the battery pack **2** to the heated jacket **10**. For example, the output port **204** may provide 26 Watts (W) to the heated jacket **10** from the battery pack **2**.

[0051] FIG. 9 illustrates a first internal view of the holder **200**. The holder **200** includes a PCB **206**, a communication port PCB **208**, a communication port **210**, a heated garment voltage port **212**, and a terminal block **214**. The communication port PCB **208** is provided adjacent to the communication port **210**. In some embodiments, the communication port PCB **208** is fixed to the communication port **210** with a screw. In some embodiments, the communication port PCB **208** and the communication port **210** are spaced apart from a first side of the PCB **206**. In some embodiments, the communication port **210** is a first port of the output port **204**. The heated garment voltage port **212** may extend from a second side, opposite the first side, of the PCB **206**. In some embodiments, the heated garment voltage port is a second port of the output port **204**. In some embodiments, the heated garment voltage port **212** has a larger diameter than the communication port **210** and may be a different type of port than the communication port **210**. Additional circuit components may be provided on the PCB **206**. The terminal block **214** may electrically and mechanically connect the battery pack **2** to the holder **200**. For example, the terminal block **214** may include mechanical interface components and electrical interface components. In some embodiments, the terminal block **214** may be electrically connected to the PCB **206**.

[0052] FIG. 10 illustrates a second internal view of the holder **200**. The battery pack **2** is partially received within the holder **200** and connected to the terminal block **214** in a bottom portion of the charger. The PCB **206** is provided in a top portion of the holder **200**.

[0053] A controller **300** for the charger **100** is illustrated in FIG. **11**. The controller **300** is electrically and/or communicatively connected to a variety of modules or components of the charger **100**. For example, the illustrated controller **300** is connected to one or more sensors **305** (which may include, for example, one or more current sensors, voltage sensors, temperature sensor, etc., or a combination thereof), one or more indicators **310**, an actuator **315**, a power supply interface **320**, and the battery pack **2**. In some embodiments, the one or more indicators **310** may include the fuel gauge **110**.

[0054] The controller **300** includes a plurality of electrical and electronic components that provide power, operational control, and protection to the components and modules within the controller **300** and/or the charger **100**. For example, the controller **300** includes, among other things, a processing unit **340** (e.g., a microprocessor, an electronic processor, an electronic controller, a microcontroller, or another suitable programmable device), a memory **345**, one or more input units **350**, and one or more output units **355**. In some embodiments, the processing unit **340** includes, among other things, a control unit **365**, an arithmetic logic unit (“ALU”) **370**, and a plurality of registers **375** (shown as a group of registers in FIG. **11**), and is implemented using one or more computer architectures (e.g., a modified Harvard architecture, a von Neumann architecture, etc.). The processing unit **340**, the memory **345**, the input units **350**, and the output units **355**, as well as the various modules connected to the controller **300** are connected by one or more control and/or data buses (e.g., common bus **360**). The control and/or data buses are shown generally in FIG. **11** for illustrative purposes. The use of one or more control and/or data buses for the interconnection between and communication among the various modules and components would be known to a person skilled in the art in view of the embodiments described herein.

[0055] The memory **345** is a non-transitory computer readable medium and includes, for example, a program storage area and a data storage area. The program storage area and the data storage area can include combinations of different types of memory, such as a ROM, a RAM (e.g., DRAM, SDRAM, etc.), EEPROM, flash memory, a hard disk, an SD card, or other suitable magnetic, optical, physical, or electronic memory devices. The processing unit **340** is connected to the memory **345** and executes software instructions that are capable of being stored in a RAM portion of the memory **345** (e.g., during execution), a ROM portion of the memory **345** (e.g., on a generally permanent basis), or another non-transitory computer readable medium, such as another memory or a disc. Software included in the implementation of the charger **100** can be stored in the memory **345** of the controller **300**. The software includes, for example, firmware, one or more applications, program data, filters, rules, one or more program modules, and other executable instructions. The controller **300** (e.g., the processing unit **340**) is configured to retrieve from the memory **345** and execute, among other things, instructions related to the control processes and methods described herein. In other embodiments, the controller **300** includes additional, fewer, or different components.

[0056] The sensors **305** may include one or more current sensors, voltage sensors, temperature sensor, etc. that provide overcurrent protection for the charger **100**, the battery pack **2**, and anything receiving/providing power at the power supply interface **320** (e.g., heated garment(s) **330** or an external device **325**). In some embodiments, the sensors **305** may determine a charge level of the battery pack **2**.

[0057] The indicators **310** receive control signals from the controller **300** to turn ON and OFF or otherwise convey information based on different states of the charger **100**, the heated garment **330**, the battery pack **2**, or a combination thereof. For example, the indicators **310** may display the power level of the battery pack **2**, that the charger **100** is in a discharge mode, or that the charger **100** is in a charge mode. The indicators **310** include, for example, one or more light-emitting diodes (LEDs), a display screen (e.g., an LCD display), or a combination thereof. The display/indicator(s) **310** may also include additional elements to convey information to a user through one or more audible outputs, tactile outputs (e.g., a speaker), or a combination thereof. The display/indicator(s)

310 may also be referred to as an output device configured to provide an output to a user. In some embodiments, the indicators **310** may illuminate to display a power level of the battery pack **2** when the charger **100** is providing a charging voltage to the battery pack **2** or when the charger **100** is providing an output voltage to a heated garment **330** and/or and external device **325**. In some embodiments, the controller **300** determines that a heated garment **330** is connected to the power supply interface **320** and automatically illuminates the indicators **310** to display a power level of the battery pack **2**.

[0058] The actuator **315** may be a power button, such as power button **108** (FIGS. 5A and 5B). The actuator **315** may provide a signal to the controller **300** when a user depresses the power button **108**. For example, the signal may be an ON/OFF signal for providing power to or ceasing the power to a device **325** coupled to the power supply interface **320**. As noted above, in some embodiments, the charger **100** may charge a device **325** (e.g., a mobile phone, a power tool, a laptop, a tablet, a smart wearable device, etc.). In some embodiments, the power button **108** may control power to the heated garment **330**, the external device **325**, or a combination thereof and, in some embodiments, also or alternatively control power to and/or from the battery pack **2**.

[0059] The power supply interface **320** is connected to the controller **300** and couples to one or more heated garments **330** (e.g., heated jacket **10** and/or heated glove **50**), a device **325**, and the battery pack **2**. In some embodiments, the power supply interface **320** includes a first connection port, such as output port **104**, that couples to the heated garment **330**, a second connection port, such as bi-directional port **114**, that couples to the device **325**, and a third connection port, such as the terminal block **124**, that couples to the battery pack **2**. The power supply interface **320** includes a combination of mechanical (e.g., output port **104**, bi-directional port **114**, terminal block **124**) and electrical components configured to and operable for interfacing (e.g., mechanically, electrically, and communicatively connecting) the charger **100** with the heated garments **330**, device **325**, and battery pack **2**. In some embodiments, the power supply interface **320** receives power from the battery pack **2** and transmits the power to the heated garments **330** and/or device **325**, for example, in a discharge mode. Additionally, in some embodiments, the power supply interface **320** receives power from the device **325** and transmits the power to at least one of the battery pack **2** and the heated garments **330**, for example, in either a charge mode or a charge mode and a discharge mode. The power supply interface **320** includes active and/or passive components (e.g., voltage step-down controllers, voltage converters, rectifiers, filters, etc.) to regulate or control the power transmitted to the heated garments **330**, device **325**, and/or battery pack **2**.

[0060] A controller **400** for the holder **200** is illustrated in FIG. **12**. The controller **400** is electrically and/or communicatively connected to a variety of modules or components of the holder **200**. For example, the illustrated controller **400** is connected to one or more sensors **405** (which may include, for example, one or more current sensors, voltage sensors, temperature sensor, etc., or a combination thereof), a power supply interface **410**, and the battery pack **2**.

[0061] The controller **400** includes a plurality of electrical and electronic components that provide power, operational control, and protection to the components and modules within the controller **400** and/or the holder **200**. For example, the controller **400** includes, among other things, a processing unit **415** (e.g., a microprocessor, an electronic processor, an electronic controller, a microcontroller, or another suitable programmable device), a memory **420**, one or more input units **425**, and one or more output units **430**. In some embodiments, the processing unit **340** includes, among other things, a control unit **440**, an arithmetic logic unit (“ALU”) **445**, and a plurality of registers **450** (shown as a group of registers in FIG. **12**), and is implemented using one or more computer architectures (e.g., a modified Harvard architecture, a von Neumann architecture, etc.). The processing unit **415**, the memory **420**, the input units **425**, and the output units **430**, as well as the various modules connected to the controller **400** are connected by one or more control and/or data buses (e.g., common bus **435**). The control and/or data buses are shown generally in FIG. **12** for illustrative purposes. The use of one or more control and/or data buses for the interconnection

between and communication among the various modules and components would be known to a person skilled in the art in view of the embodiments described herein.

[0062] The memory **420** is a non-transitory computer readable medium and includes, for example, a program storage area and a data storage area. The program storage area and the data storage area can include combinations of different types of memory, such as a ROM, a RAM (e.g., DRAM, SDRAM, etc.), EEPROM, flash memory, a hard disk, an SD card, or other suitable magnetic, optical, physical, or electronic memory devices. The processing unit **415** is connected to the memory **420** and executes software instruction that are capable of being stored in a RAM portion of the memory **420** (e.g., during execution), a ROM portion of the memory **420** (e.g., on a generally permanent basis), or another non-transitory computer readable medium, such as another memory or a disc. Software included in the implementation of the holder **200** can be stored in the memory **420** of the controller **400**. The software includes, for example, firmware, one or more applications, program data, filters, rules, one or more program modules, and other executable instructions. The controller **400** (e.g., the processing unit **415**) is configured to retrieve from the memory **420** and execute, among other things, instructions related to the control processes and methods described herein. In other embodiments, the controller **400** includes additional, fewer, or different components.

[0063] The sensors **405** may include one or more current sensors, voltage sensors, temperature sensor, etc. that provide overcurrent protection for the holder **200**, the battery pack **2**, and anything receiving/providing power at the power supply interface **410** (e.g., heated garment(s) **330**). In some embodiments, the sensors **405** may determine a charge level of the battery pack **2**.

[0064] The power supply interface **410** is connected to the controller **400** and couples to one or more heated garments **330** (e.g., heated jacket **10** and/or heated glove **50**) and the battery pack **2**. In some embodiments, the power supply interface **410** includes a first connection port, such as output port **204**, that couples to the heated garment **330** and a second connection port, such as the terminal block **214**, that couples to the battery pack **2**. The power supply interface **410** includes a combination of mechanical (e.g., output port **204** and terminal block **214**) and electrical components configured to and operable for interfacing (e.g., mechanically, electrically, and communicatively connecting) the holder **200** with the heated garments **330** and battery pack **2**. In some embodiments, the power supply interface **410** receives power from the battery pack **2** and transmits the power to the heated garments **330**, for example, in a discharge mode. The power supply interface **410** includes active and/or passive components (e.g., voltage step-down controllers, voltage converters, rectifiers, filters, etc.) to regulate or control the power transmitted to the heated garments **330**.

[0065] A controller **500** for a heated garment is illustrated in FIG. **13**. The controller **500** is electrically and/or communicatively connected to a variety of modules or components of the heated garment, such as heated jacket **10** (FIG. **2**). For example, the illustrated controller **500** is connected to one or more sensors **505** (which may include, for example, current sensors, voltage sensors, temperature sensor, timers, etc., or a combination thereof), one or more indicators **510**, one or more heater arrays **26**, a power supply interface **515**, and a power receive interface **520**. In some embodiments, the controller **500** may be connected to a heated garment wireless communication controller (not shown) included in the heated garment. For example, the heated jacket **10** may wirelessly communicate with the battery pack **2**, the charger **100**, the holder **200** or each via the heated garment wireless communication controller.

[0066] The controller **500** includes a plurality of electrical and electronic components that provide power, operational control, and protection to the components and modules within the controller **500** and/or heated garment. For example, the controller **500** includes, among other things, a processing unit **530** (e.g., a microprocessor, an electronic processor, an electronic controller, a microcontroller, or another suitable programmable device), a memory **535**, input units **540**, and output units **545**. The processing unit **530** includes, among other things, a control unit **555**, an arithmetic logic unit

(“ALU”) **560**, and a plurality of registers **265** (shown as a group of registers in FIG. **13**), and is implemented using one or more computer architecture (e.g., a modified Harvard architecture, a von Neumann architecture, etc.). The processing unit **530**, the memory **535**, the input units **540**, and the output units **545**, as well as the various modules connected to the controller **500** are connected by one or more control and/or data buses (e.g., common bus **550**). The control and/or data buses are shown generally in FIG. **13** for illustrative purposes. The use of one or more control and/or data buses for the interconnection between and communication among the various modules and components would be known to a person skilled in the art in view of the embodiments described herein.

[0067] The memory **535** is a non-transitory computer readable medium and includes, for example, a program storage area and a data storage area. The program storage area and the data storage area can include combinations of different types of memory, such as a ROM, a RAM (e.g., DRAM, SDRAM, etc.), EEPROM, flash memory, a hard disk, an SD card, or other suitable magnetic, optical, physical, or electronic memory devices. The processing unit **530** is connected to the memory **535** and executes software instructions that are capable of being stored in a RAM portion of the memory **535** (e.g., during execution), a ROM portion of the memory **535** (e.g., on a generally permanent basis), or another non-transitory computer readable medium, such as another memory or a disc. Software included in the implementation of the heated garment can be stored in the memory **535** of the controller **500**. The software includes, for example, firmware, one or more applications, program data, filters, rules, one or more program modules, and other executable instructions. The controller **500** is configured to retrieve from the memory **535** and execute, among other things, instructions related to the control processes and methods described herein. In other embodiments, the controller **500** includes additional, fewer, or different components.

[0068] The indicators **510** receive control signals from the controller **500** to turn ON and OFF or otherwise convey information based on different states of the heated garment **10**. For example, the indicators **510** may display that the heater array **26** is ON, that the battery pack **2** is out of power, etc. The indicators **510** include, for example, one or more light-emitting diodes (LEDs), a display screen (e.g., an LCD display), or a combination thereof. The display/indicator(s) **515** may also include additional elements to convey information to a user through one or more audible outputs, tactile outputs (e.g., a speaker), or a combination thereof. The display/indicator(s) **510** may also be referred to as an output device configured to provide an output to a user.

[0069] The power supply interface **515** is connected to the controller **500** and couples to a heated garment controller **525**. The power supply interface **515** supplies power from the battery pack **2** to another heated garment (i.e., the heated garment controller **215** included in such “other” heated garment). In some embodiments, the heated garment controller **525** may include at least some of the same components as the controller **500**. As noted, the heated garment controller **525** is within a heated garment separate from the heated garment including the controller **500**. For example, the controller **500** may be included in the heated jacket **10** (FIG. **2**) and the heated garment controller **525** may be included in the heated glove **50** (FIG. **4**). The power supply interface **515** includes a combination of mechanical (e.g., a connector) and electrical components configured to and operable for interfacing (e.g., mechanically, electrically, and communicatively connecting) the heated garment with another heated garment.

[0070] The power receive interface **520** is connected to the controller **500** and couples to the battery pack charger controller **300** or the battery pack holder controller **400** to receive power from the battery pack **2**. The power receive interface **520** includes a combination of mechanical (e.g., a connector) and electrical components configured to and operable for interfacing (e.g., mechanically, electrically, and communicatively connecting) the heated garment with the charger **100** or the holder **200**. In some embodiments, the power receive interface **520** also receives data from the charger controller **300** or the holder controller **400**. For example, the controller **500** may receive a temperature control signal from the charger controller **300** or the holder controller **400** via

the power receive interface **520**.

[0071] In some embodiments, the power supply interface **515** facilitates both power and data transfer to the heated garment controller **525**. However, in other embodiments, a separate interface may be used to communicate information between the controller **500**, the charger **100**, the holder **200**, the battery pack **2**, or other components of the heated garment **10** and the heated garment controller **525**, including, for example, a wireless communication connection in some embodiments. For example, the charger controller **300** may provide a temperature control signal (e.g., processed or unprocessed) to the controller **500** and/or the heated garment controller **525** via the controller **500**. The temperature control signal may include a portion associated with the controller **500** as well as a portion associated with the heated garment controller **525** and such portions may be associated with unique identifiers of each controller, which may allow the controller **500**, the power supply interface **515**, or other component in the heated garment **10** to determine what portion of the signal is intended for what controller and, as such, may forward the portion designated for the heated garment controller **525** via the power supply interface **515**. In some embodiments, rather than indirectly communicating with the heated garment controller **525** through the controller **500**, the charger **100** or the holder **200** may directly communicate with the heated garment controller **525** via one or more wired or wireless communication channels.

[0072] FIG. **14A** illustrates a dual connector **630** from a heated garment, such as heated jacket **10** (FIG. **2**). The dual connector **630** connects the heated jacket **10** to one of the charger **100** and the holder **200**. In some embodiments, the dual connector **630** extends as a wire from the heated jacket **10**. The dual connector **630** includes a dual barrel connection portion including a first connection portion **635** and a second connection portion **640**. For example, the first connection portion **635** may be a barrel-style connector and the second connection portion **640** may also be a barrel-style connector that is smaller in diameter than the first connection portion **635**. The first connection portion **635** facilitates power (e.g., 12V, 18W) from the battery pack **2** to the heater array **26** of the heated jacket **10** and the second connection portion **640** communications data to one of the charger **100**, the holder **200**, and the battery pack **2** from the heated jacket **10**.

[0073] FIG. **14B** illustrates the output port **104** of a battery pack charger, such as the charger **100** with a cover **648** positioned over the output port **104**. The output port **104** receives the dual connector **630** from the heated jacket and facilitates an electrical connection between the battery pack **2** and the heated jacket **10**. As illustrated in FIG. **14B**, the cover **648** may include protrusions **650** and **655** that generally align with the two ports of the output port **104** (a first port **104A** and a second **104B** as illustrated in FIGS. **5A** and **5B**) that are accessible when the cover **648** is removed (e.g., removed via a snap or friction fit connection or pivoted or slid out of the position illustrated in FIG. **14B**). The first port **104A** receives the first connection portion **635** and the second port **104B** receives the second connection portion **640**. In some of the embodiments, the first port **104A** is the heated garment voltage port **120** and the second port **104B** is the communication port **116**. In some embodiments, the first port **104A** is a 12V power port that provides a 26 watt (W) output. In some embodiments, the output port **104** may have over current protection characteristics. For example, the over current protection characteristic enables the charger **100** to remain functional when an over-current event occurs. In some embodiments, the output port **104** may self-heal after the over-current event (e.g., after the dual connector **630** is disconnected from the output port **104**).

[0074] FIG. **14C** illustrates the charger **100** of FIG. **5B** with a cover **648**. In this implementation, the cover **648** may fit within the ridge **111** and may be attached (e.g., through a snap or friction fit with the attachment member **112**). As illustrated in FIG. **14C**, the cover **648** may include a detent or handle **654** that allows a user to grip the cover **648** and move the cover **648** to access the output port **104**.

[0075] FIG. **14D** illustrates the output port **204** of a battery pack holder, such as the holder **200**. The output port **204** receives the dual connector **630** from the heated jacket and facilitates an electrical connection between the battery pack **2** and the heated jacket **10**. The output port **204**

includes a first port **660** and a second port **665**. The first port **660** receives the first connection portion **635** and the second port **665** receives the second connection portion **640**. In some of the embodiments, the first port **660** is the heated garment voltage port **212** and the second port **655** is the communication port **210**. In some embodiments, the first port **660** is a 12V power port that provides a 26 watt (W) output. In some embodiments, the output port **204** may have over current protection characteristics. For example, the over current protection characteristic enables the holder **200** to remain functional when an over-current event occurs. In some embodiments, the output port **204** may self-heal after the over-current event (e.g., after the dual connector **630** is disconnected from the output port **204**).

[0076] FIG. **15** illustrates a user interface **700** for the heated garment **10**. The user interface **700** includes one or more lighting components **705**, such as LEDs, that may change color and/or intensity. In some embodiments, the user interface **700** conveys information to a user wearing the heated garment by changing color and/or intensity of the lighting components **705**. For example, the lighting components **705** of the user interface **700** may turn OFF when the heater array **26** of the heated jacket **10** is turned OFF (e.g., one of the charger **100** and the holder **200** is disconnected from the heated jacket **10**, the battery pack **2** is out of power, etc.). It should be understood that various colors, intensities, blinking patterns, or a combination thereof may be used to convey information via the user interface **700**.

[0077] FIG. **16** illustrates a user interface **710** of the charger **100**. The user interface **710** includes one or more interactive elements, such as one or more buttons, that send a signal to the charger controller **300** to perform a function and, in some embodiments, one or more passive elements, such as LEDs, that convey information to a user. For example, the user interface **710** may include the cover **106** (covering the bi-directional port **114**), the power button **108**, and the fuel gauge **110**. The power button **108** may be pressed output power from the battery pack **2** to the external device **325** and may be pressed again to disable the flow of power from the battery pack **2** to the external device **325**. As another example, the power button **108** may be pressed to enable charging power to flow from the external device **325** to the battery pack **2**. The power button **108** may be a back lit button, and the button may be lit (e.g., with a white LED) to indicate that the bi-direction port **114** is on. In other embodiments, the user interface **710** may include an indicator for providing a status of the bi-direction port **114** separate from the power button **108**. The fuel gauge **110** may display a level of charge of the battery pack **2** when the battery pack **2** is received by the charger **100**. Additionally, the fuel gauge **110** may indicate an error status of one of the charger **100** and the battery pack **2** (e.g., an overcurrent condition, an overtemperature condition, a loss of connection with the external device **325**, etc.). In some embodiments, the fuel gauge **110** may include four LEDs, such as, for example, four red LEDs.

[0078] FIG. **17** illustrates a power distribution network **800** for the charger **100**. As noted above, in some embodiments, the charger **100** provides power to the heated jacket **10** (e.g., from the battery pack **2** connected to the charger **100**) and provides power to/receives power from the external device **325** at separate power ports (e.g., the output port **104** and the bi-directional port **114**). In some embodiments, the charger **100** provides data along with power to the heated jacket **10**. In some embodiments, the charger **100** provides output power to the external device **325** and the heated jacket **10** simultaneously. In some embodiments, the charger **100** receives power from the external device **325** while simultaneously providing power to the heated jacket **10**. In embodiments where the charger **100** is receiving input power from the external device **325**, the external device **325** may be an inverter coupled to a conventional wall outlet.

[0079] FIG. **18** illustrates a power distribution network **900** for the holder **200**. As noted above, in some embodiments, the holder **200** provides power to the heated jacket **10** (e.g., from the battery pack **2** connected to the holder **200**). In some embodiments, the holder **200** provides data along with power to the heated jacket **10**.

[0080] FIG. **19** is a method **1000** for operating the charger **100**. Although the illustrated method

1000 includes specific steps, not all of the steps need to be performed or need to be performed in the order presented. In some embodiments, the method **1000** is executed by the charger controller **300** (e.g., by execution of a software program by the processing unit **415**).

[0081] The method **1000** includes the controller **300** determining that a battery pack **2** is received by the travel battery pack charger **100** (step **1005**). In some embodiments, the controller **300** determines that a battery pack **2** is received by the charger **100** based on an input from at least one of a current sensor, a voltage sensor, the terminal block **124**, and the power supply interface **320**. For example, the controller **300** may determine that the battery pack **2** is received by the charger **100** based on an input from the terminal block **124** when the battery pack **2** is electrically connected to the terminal block **124**. In step **1010**, the controller **300** determines that a heated garment is coupled to the charger **100**. In some embodiments, the controller **300** determines that the heated jacket **10** is coupled to the charger **100** based on an input from at least one of a current sensor, a voltage sensor, the output port **104**, and the power supply interface **320**.

[0082] In step **1015**, the controller **300** provides a first output current to the heated garment. For example, the controller **300** facilitates an output current from the battery pack **2** to the heated jacket **10**. In some embodiments, the output current flows from the heated garment voltage port **120** to the heated jacket **10**. In step **1020**, the controller **300** determines that an external device **325** is coupled to the charger **100**. In some embodiments, the controller **300** determines that the external device **325** is coupled to the charger **100** based on an input from at least one of a current sensor, a voltage sensor, the bi-directional power port **114**, the power supply interface **320**, and an input from the power button **108**. The external device **325** may be connected to the charger **100** at the bi-directional power port **114**.

[0083] At decision step **1025**, the controller **300** determines whether to provide an output current to the external device **325** or to receive a charging current from the external device **325**. In some embodiments, the controller **300** may determine whether to provide an output current to the external device **325** or to receive a charging current from the external device **325** based on an input signal from the power button **108**. For example, a single actuation of the power button **108** may send an output current signal to the controller **300** and a quick double-tap actuation of the power button **108** may send a charging current signal to the controller **300**. As another example, the controller **300** may determine that the external device **325** contains more stored voltage than available in the battery pack **2**. Based upon the determination that the external device **325** has a greater voltage than the battery pack **2**, the controller **300** may draw a charging current from the external device **325** to the charger **100** (e.g., so the charger **100** may provide the charging current to the battery pack **2**). Alternatively or additionally, in some embodiments, when the controller **300** is actively providing a first output current to the heated jacket **10**, the charger **100** may be unable to receive a charging current, thus, the controller **300** may automatically provide an output current to the external device **325** when the external device **325** is coupled to the charger **100** and power is being provided to the heated jacket **10**. When the controller **300** determines that an output current will be provided to the external device **325**, the method **1000** proceeds to step **1030**. When the controller **300** determines that a charging current will be received from the external device **325**, the method **1000** proceeds to step **1035**.

[0084] In step **1030**, the controller **300** provides a second output current to the external device **325**. In some embodiments, the second output current is less than the first output current. Alternatively, in some embodiments, the second output current is the same as the first output current. In some embodiments, the first output current to the heated jacket **10** decreases when the controller **300** provides the second output current to the external device. In step **1035**, the controller **300** receives a charging current from the external device **325**. In some embodiments, the controller **300** ceases to provide the first output current to the heated jacket **10** when the controller **300** receives a charging current.

[0085] In some embodiments, the controller **300** performs steps **1020-1035** without first

performing steps **1005-1015**. For example, the controller **300** may provide an output current or receive a charging current to/from the external device **325** while not being coupled to the heated jacket **10**.

[0086] FIG. **20** is a method **1100** of the controller **400** operating the holder **200**. Although the illustrated method **1100** includes specific steps, not all of the steps need to be performed or need to be performed in the order presented. In some embodiments, the method **1100** is executed by the battery pack holder controller **400** (e.g., by execution of a software program by the processing unit **530**).

[0087] The method **1100** includes the controller **400** determining that a battery pack **2** is received by the battery pack holder **200** (step **1105**). In some embodiments, the controller **400** determines that a battery pack **2** is received by the holder **200** based on an input from at least one of a current sensor, a voltage sensor, the terminal block **214**, and the power supply interface **410**. In step **1015**, the controller **400** determines that a heated garment is coupled to the holder **200**. In some embodiments, the controller **400** determines that the heated jacket **10** is coupled to the holder **200** based on an input from at least one of a current sensor, a voltage sensor, the output port **204**, and the power supply interface **410**. In step **1115**, the controller **400** provides an output current to the heated garment. For example, the controller **400** facilitates an output current from the battery pack **2** to the heated jacket **10**. In some embodiments, the output current flows from the heated garment voltage port **212** to the heated jacket.

[0088] Thus, embodiments described herein provide, among other things, a travel battery pack charger and a battery pack holder. Various features and advantages are set forth in the following claims.

Claims

1. A battery pack accessory, comprising: a cylindrical housing; a terminal block supported by the cylindrical housing and configured to connect to a battery pack; an output port provided on the cylindrical housing for providing an output current to a heated garment; and a controller located within the cylindrical housing and including an electronic processor and a memory, the controller coupled to the terminal block and the output port, the controller configured to: determine that the battery pack is connected to the terminal block, determine that the heated garment is coupled to the battery pack accessory at the output port, and provide the output current to the heated garment in response to determining that the battery pack is connected to the terminal block and the heated garment is coupled to the battery pack accessory at the output port.
2. The battery pack accessory of claim 1, wherein the battery pack accessory is configured to partially receive the battery pack within the cylindrical housing.
3. The battery pack accessory of claim 1, wherein the output port is a dual barrel output port.
4. The battery pack accessory of claim 3, wherein a first barrel of the dual barrel output port is a power port providing the output current to the heated garment and a second barrel of the dual barrel output port is a communication port providing communication signals from the controller to the heated garment.
5. The battery pack accessory of claim 1, wherein the battery pack is a 12 volt (V) battery pack.
6. The battery pack accessory of claim 1, wherein the output port is provided along a longitudinal axis of the cylindrical housing.
7. The battery pack accessory of claim 1, wherein the battery pack accessory is configured to be received by a compartment within the heated garment.
8. The battery pack accessory of claim 1, further comprising: a bi-directional port provided on the cylindrical housing for providing a second output current to an external device and receiving a charging current from the external device.
9. The battery pack accessory of claim 8, further comprising: a power button provided on the

cylindrical housing, wherein the controller is further configured to enable the second output current to be provided to the external device via the bi-directional port in response to receiving a signal from the power button when actuated.

10. The battery pack accessory of claim 1, further comprising: a fuel gauge provided on the cylindrical housing for providing a visual indication of a charge level of the battery pack.

11. A system comprising: a battery pack, and a battery pack accessory, the battery pack accessory including: a cylindrical housing; a terminal block supported by the cylindrical housing and configured to connect to the battery pack; an output port provided on the cylindrical housing for providing an output current to a heated garment; and a controller located within the cylindrical housing and including an electronic processor and a memory, the controller coupled to the terminal block and the output port, the controller configured to: determine that the battery pack is connected to the terminal block, determine that the heated garment is coupled to the battery pack accessory at the output port, and provide the output current to the heated garment in response to determining that the battery pack is connected to the terminal block and determining that the heated garment is coupled to the battery pack accessory at the output port.

12. The system of claim 11, wherein the battery pack accessory further includes: a first printed circuit board supported by the cylindrical housing.

13. The system of claim 12, wherein battery pack is received by the battery pack accessory at a first end and the first printed circuit board is provided at a second end of the battery pack accessory, wherein the second end is opposite the first end along a longitudinal axis.

14. The system of claim 12, wherein the output port includes a communication port provided on a first side of the first printed circuit board and a voltage port provided a second side, opposite the first side, of the first printed circuit board.

15. The system of claim 12, wherein the battery pack accessory further includes: a second printed circuit board provided below the first printed circuit board, and a third printed circuit board provided below the second printed circuit board.

16. A method of providing an output current to a heated garment from a battery pack, the method comprising: determining, with a controller of a battery pack accessory, that the battery pack is connected to a terminal block of the battery pack accessory; determining, with the controller of the battery pack accessory, that the heated garment is coupled to the battery pack accessory, wherein the heated garment is coupled to the battery pack accessory at an output port; and in response to determining that the battery pack is connected to the terminal block and the heated garment is coupled to the battery pack accessory at the output port, providing, with the controller of the battery pack accessory, a first output current from the battery pack to the heated garment.

17. The method of claim 16 further comprising: determining, with the controller of the battery pack accessory, that an external device is coupled to the battery pack accessory, wherein the external device is coupled to the battery pack accessory at a bi-directional port.

18. The method of claim 17 further comprising: receiving, with the controller of the battery pack accessory, an output current signal from a power button of the battery pack accessory; and providing, with the controller of the battery pack accessory, a second output current to the external device in response to receiving the output current signal from the power button and determining that the external device is coupled to the battery pack accessory.

19. The method of claim 17 further comprising: receiving, with the controller of the battery pack accessory, a charging current signal from a power button of the battery pack accessory; and receiving, with the controller of the battery pack accessory, a charging current from the external device in response to receiving the charging current signal from the power button and determining that the external device is coupled to the battery pack accessory.

20. The method of claim 16, wherein the output port is a dual barrel port including a first port for providing the output current and a second port for communicating with the heated garment.
